Answer: Form validation is a critical aspect of web development that ensures users input data correctly and securely before it is submitted to the server. A user-friendly experience is achieved by implementing both client-side and server-side validation.

Client-side validation is performed directly in the browser using JavaScript, HTML5 attributes (such as `required`, `type`, `pattern`, and `minlength`), or frameworks like React, Angular, or Vue. Client-side validation provides immediate feedback to users, improving usability and reducing unnecessary server requests. For example, in React, controlled components—where form values are managed by React state—allow validation to occur as users type or when the form is submitted. By handling all form data through state updates and events, controlled components ensure consistent validation and user experience.

Server-side validation is essential for security and data integrity, as client-side validation can be bypassed. It is performed on the server after the form is submitted, checking for malicious input, data consistency, and business logic requirements. Server-side validation ensures that only valid and safe data is processed or stored.

Best practices in form validation include providing clear error messages to guide users in correcting their input, as well as validating both required and optional fields according to application requirements. Pairing `<label>` elements with form controls and using ARIA attributes where appropriate enhances accessibility, e.g.:

```
<label for="email">Email</label>
<input type="email" id="email" name="email" aria-required="true"
<span id="email-error" role="alert" aria-live="assertive"></span>
```

Performing validation on both the client and server sides helps balance user experience with security, and it is crucial to avoid relying solely on client-side validation for sensitive operations or data.

When time allows, this topic can be explored in greater depth. However, even at a high level, it is important to recognize the strategies and best practices that ensure performant and secure form validation in modern web development.